

# Tiv Animals: English Names, Classification, and Symbolic Meaning

Prepared for Tiv Archive Dictionary Seeding

This document arranges the animals into a single archive-ready table with Tiv name, English name, classification, and symbolic meaning.

| Tiv Name        | English Name             | Classification   | Symbolic Meaning                                                                                 |
|-----------------|--------------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Anyam           | Leopard                  | Wild             | Power, ancestral aggression, spiritual authority, and anti-witchcraft force; used in Igbe rites. |
| Bagu            | Monkey                   | Wild             | Linked to mystical transformation, spiritual embodiment, and external soul symbolism.            |
| Bua-u-Tiv / Bua | Tiv native cow / cow     | Domestic         | Associated with human life, sacred property, ritual caution, and spiritual consequences.         |
| Nyinya          | Horse                    | Domestic         | Symbol of strength, speed, war defence, and mystical transportation.                             |
| Iywa / Iwya     | Dog                      | Pet / Domestic   | Believed to see both physical and metaphysical realities; detects spirits, evil, and omens.      |
| Apu             | Vulture                  | Wild             | Mystical bird associated with spiritual communication and witchcraft symbolism.                  |
| Avungu / Ivungu | Owl                      | Wild             | Strong symbol of ancestors, unseen world, witchcraft, and spiritual communication.               |
| Gbev            | Standard-winged nightjar | Wild             | Nocturnal mystical bird linked to spirits, witchcraft, and spiritual movement.                   |
| Swande          | Violet turako            | Wild             | Associated with sight, spiritual journeys, and ritual transformation.                            |
| Akiki           | Pearl-spotted owl        | Wild             | Owl species associated with ancestral presence and mystical communication.                       |
| Kpile           | Barred owl               | Wild             | Owl species used in spiritual symbolism and ancestral communication.                             |
| Mtsaan / Mitsan | African scops owl        | Wild             | Owl species connected with spirits and mystical mediation.                                       |
| Kulugh / Kurugh | Tortoise                 | Wild             | Symbol of patience, caution, confidence; shell used in divination.                               |
| Iyô / Ayô       | Snake                    | Wild             | General symbol of protection, power, sexuality, ancestors, water, and the underworld.            |
| Gbaka           | Snake (specific kind)    | Wild             | Part of Tiv serpent symbolism and shrine protection imagery.                                     |
| Kyarem          | Green snake              | Wild             | Symbol of divine intervention and protection during Tiv migration.                               |
| Kyume           | Python                   | Wild             | Sacred snake symbol of Tiv gods; manifestation of divine warning.                                |
| Gungun          | Mystical snake           | Wild / Spiritual | Protective mystical serpent believed to destroy evil visitors.                                   |
| Shimbe          | Civet                    | Wild             | Animal skin used by priests and ritual specialists in divine office.                             |
| Yongô / Yongo   | Sheep                    | Domestic         | Skin used in ritual regalia and spiritual mediation.                                             |
| Ivo             | Goat                     | Domestic         | Used in ritual regalia and among domesticated symbolic animals.                                  |
| Ihyô / Ihyo     | Antelope                 | Wild             | Protective and divinatory animal; linked to invisibility and fortune.                            |

| Tiv Name         | English Name          | Classification  | Symbolic Meaning                                                                                |
|------------------|-----------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Imunan           | Mosquito              | Wild            | Used symbolically in tattoo/scarification tied to spiritual identity.                           |
| Ishu             | Fish                  | Wild            | Used in symbolic tattoo/scarification traditions.                                               |
| Gbargbar         | Fish type             | Wild            | Part of fish-related tattoo symbolism.                                                          |
| Kov              | Fish type             | Wild            | Part of tattoo symbolism in spiritual confraternity.                                            |
| Okpoto           | Fish type             | Wild            | Part of tattoo symbolism in spiritual confraternity.                                            |
| Ndiar            | Water monitor         | Wild            | Tattoo symbol used in religious and spiritual identity marking.                                 |
| Yese             | Scorpion              | Wild            | Tattoo symbol used on palms and forearms.                                                       |
| Kpatuma          | Cat                   | Pet / Domestic  | Used in mystical sound symbolism, welfare rites, and domestic life.                             |
| Ikyegh           | Chicken               | Domestic        | Important in healing, ritual cleansing, and therapeutic substitution.                           |
| Igyô / Igyô tohô | Pig / wild guinea pig | Domestic / Wild | Used through teeth or animal parts as protective symbolic material; also appears in ceremonies. |
| Ambe             | Crocodile             | Wild            | Part of protective and spiritual symbolic objects.                                              |
| Alom             | Hare                  | Wild            | Appears among symbolic animal imageries.                                                        |
| Bon              | Wildcat               | Wild            | Appears among symbolic animal imageries.                                                        |
| Begha            | Lion                  | Wild            | Represents strength, power of the Supreme Being, and ancestral force.                           |
| Nor              | Elephant              | Wild            | Represents fierce power; also linked to mystical embodiment.                                    |
| Yar              | Buffalo               | Wild            | Wild animal associated with strength and divine power.                                          |
| Chongo           | Fox                   | Wild            | Wild animal listed in Tiv classification.                                                       |
| Iguve            | Eagle                 | Wild            | Bird among fierce/wild animals with spiritual potency.                                          |